GAMING PUBLISHER ANALYSIS

Who Dominates, How, and Why?

131,884 games • 3 platforms • 51,193 publishers

Poi • Workintech Data Science • March 2026

THE QUESTION

In a market of 131K+ games across Steam, PlayStation, and Xbox...

1. Which publishers dominate which platforms?
2. How do genre specializations differ?
3. How do pricing strategies impact market position?

Methodology: BigQuery SQL (Bronze → Silver → Gold) → Python (Plotly, scipy, scikit-learn) → Presentation

DATA AT A GLANCE

131,884
Games Analyzed

3
Platforms

51,193
Publishers

18
Tables Built

Data Pipeline

Bronze: Raw upload & cleaning — 6 tables, 131K clean rows

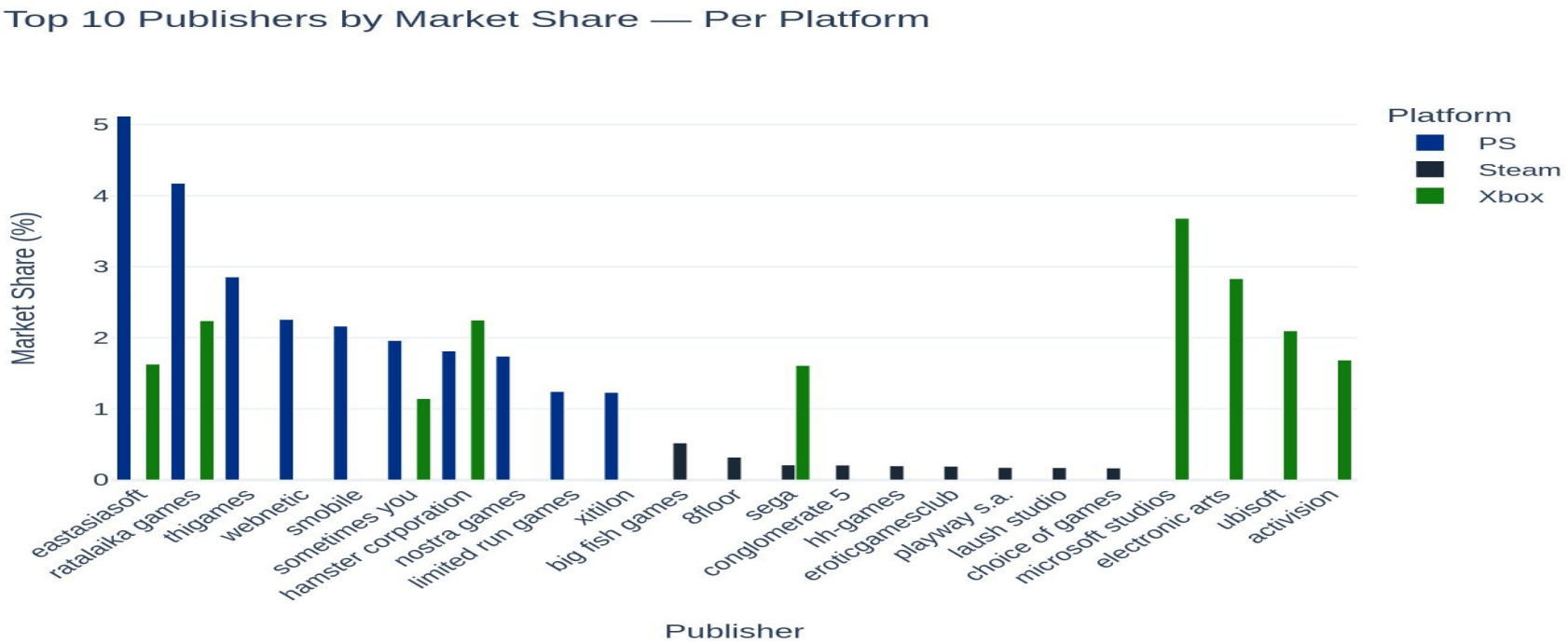
Silver: Master tables & joins — publisher parsing with REGEXP

Gold: Deep analysis — 7 queries, market share to clustering

FINDING #1

No Single Publisher Dominates Any Platform

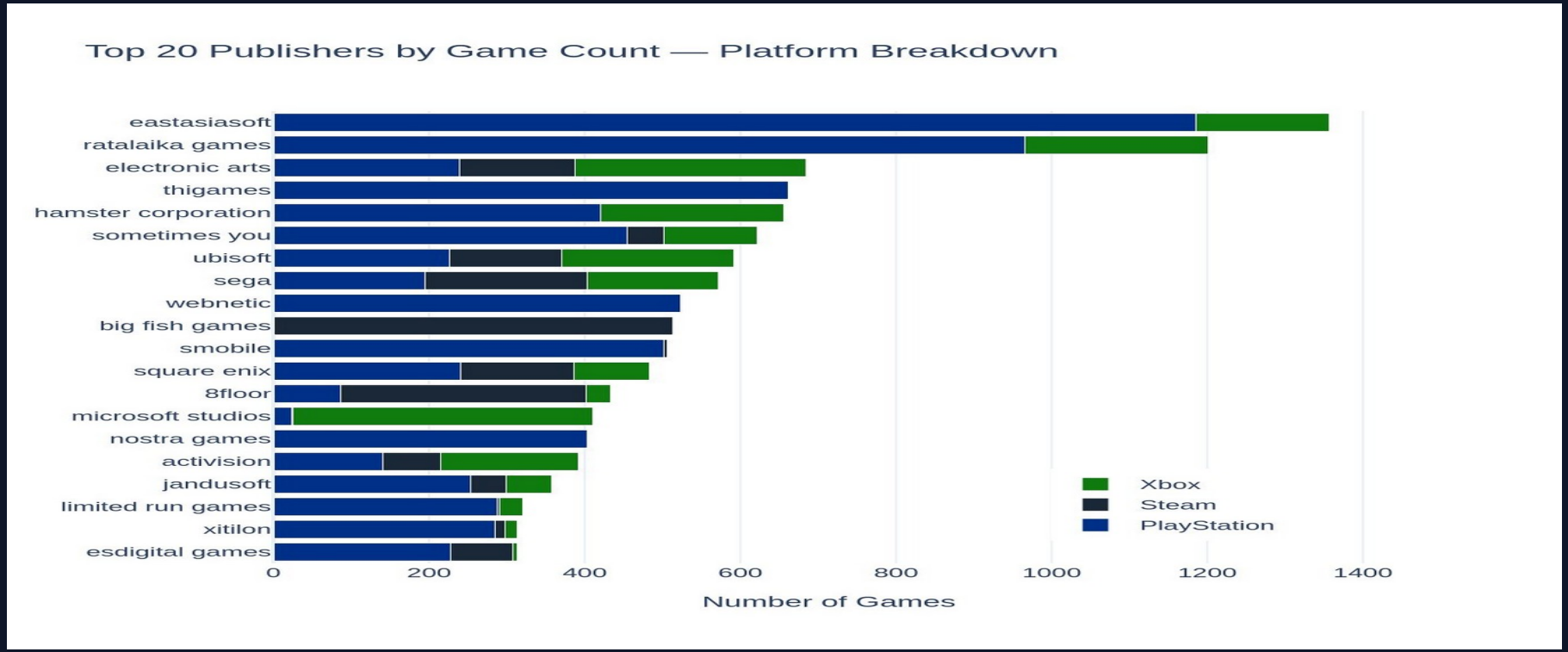
Steam's top known publisher holds just 0.52% of total games. Each platform has completely different top players.



FINDING #2

Two Publisher Models in the Top 20

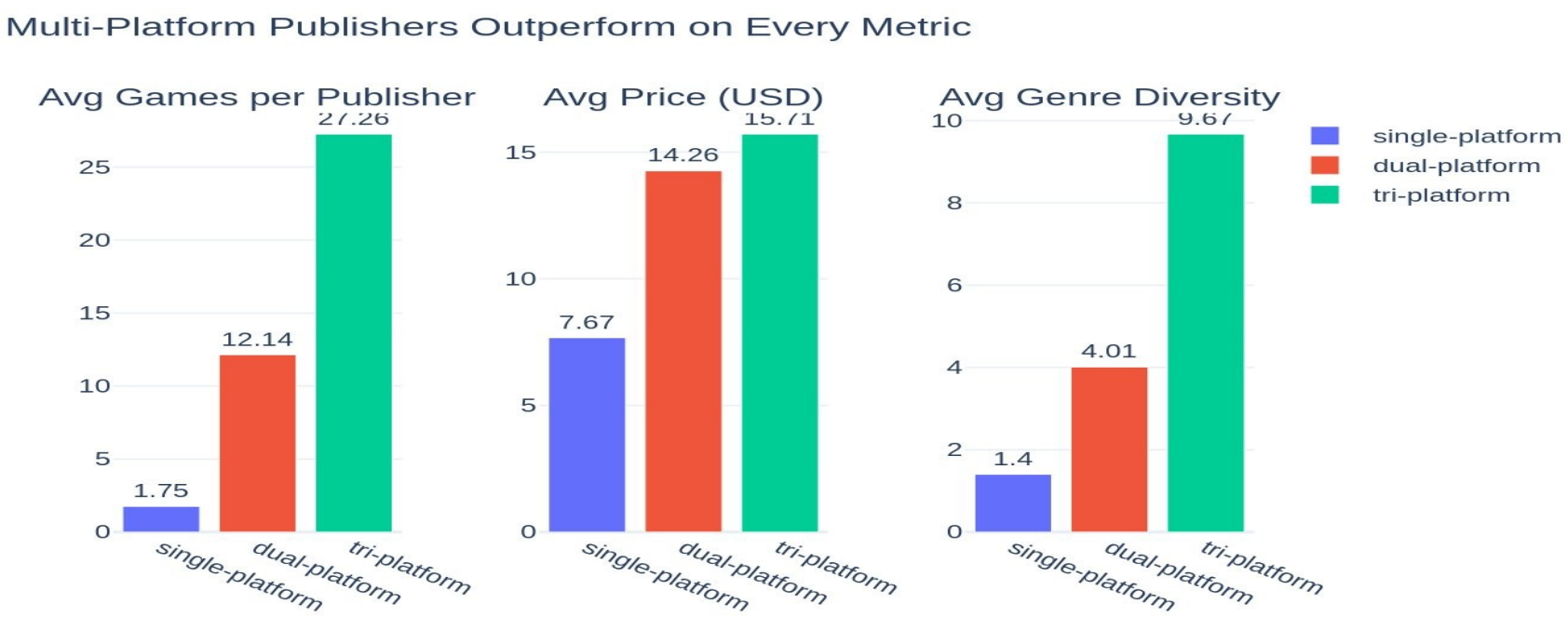
AAA publishers (EA, Ubisoft, Sega) go tri-platform at $22–30. Volume publishers (Eastasiasoft, Ratalaika) flood PS at $2–8.



FINDING #3

95% of Publishers Are Single-Platform

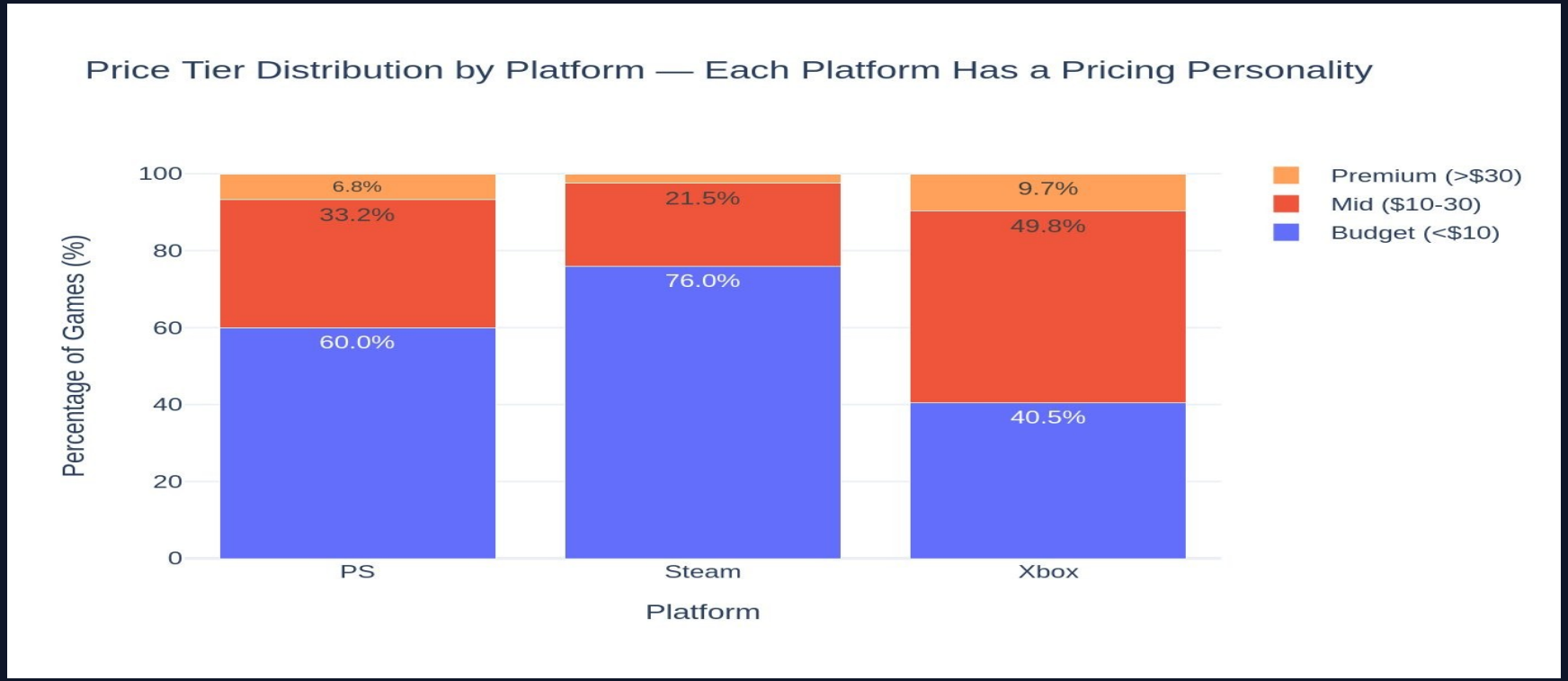
Tri-platform publishers (just 2%) publish 15× more games, charge 2× the price, and cover 7× more genres.



FINDING #4

Each Platform Has a Pricing Personality

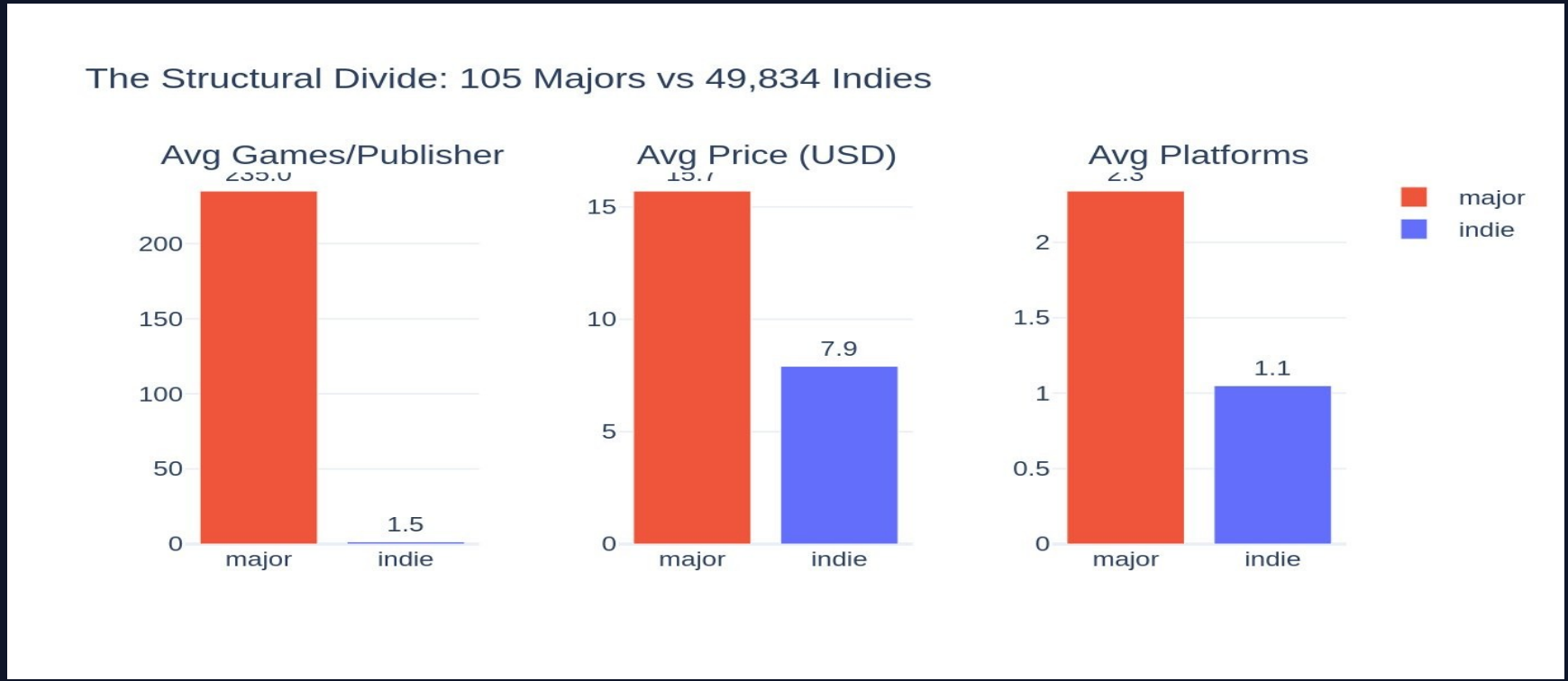
Steam is 76% budget (<$10). PlayStation is balanced. Xbox leans mid-range. Premium is <10% everywhere.



FINDING #5

The Structural Divide: 105 Majors vs 49,834 Indies

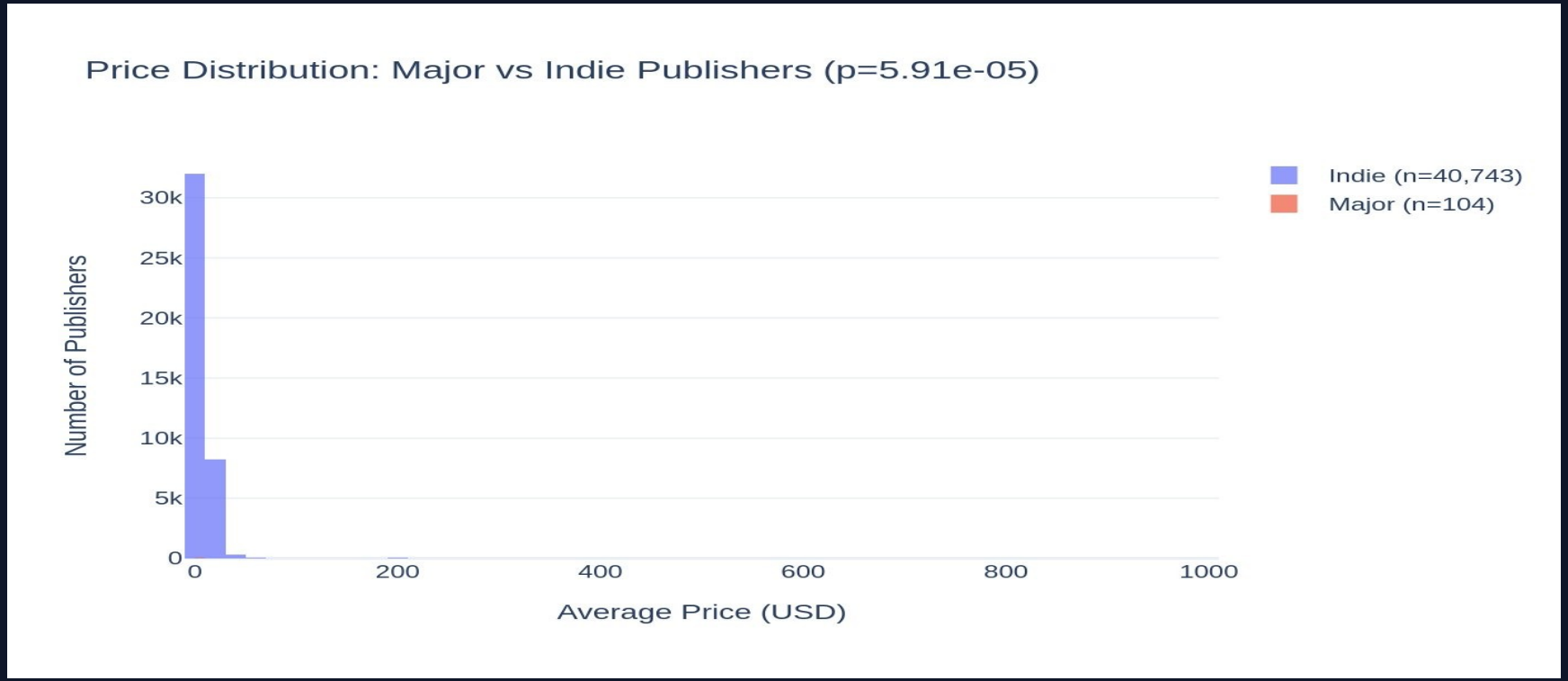
96.6% of indie publishers are locked to a single platform. Only 25% of majors are. Majors charge 2× more and operate on 2.3 platforms.



STATISTICAL VALIDATION

Major vs Indie Pricing: p < 0.001

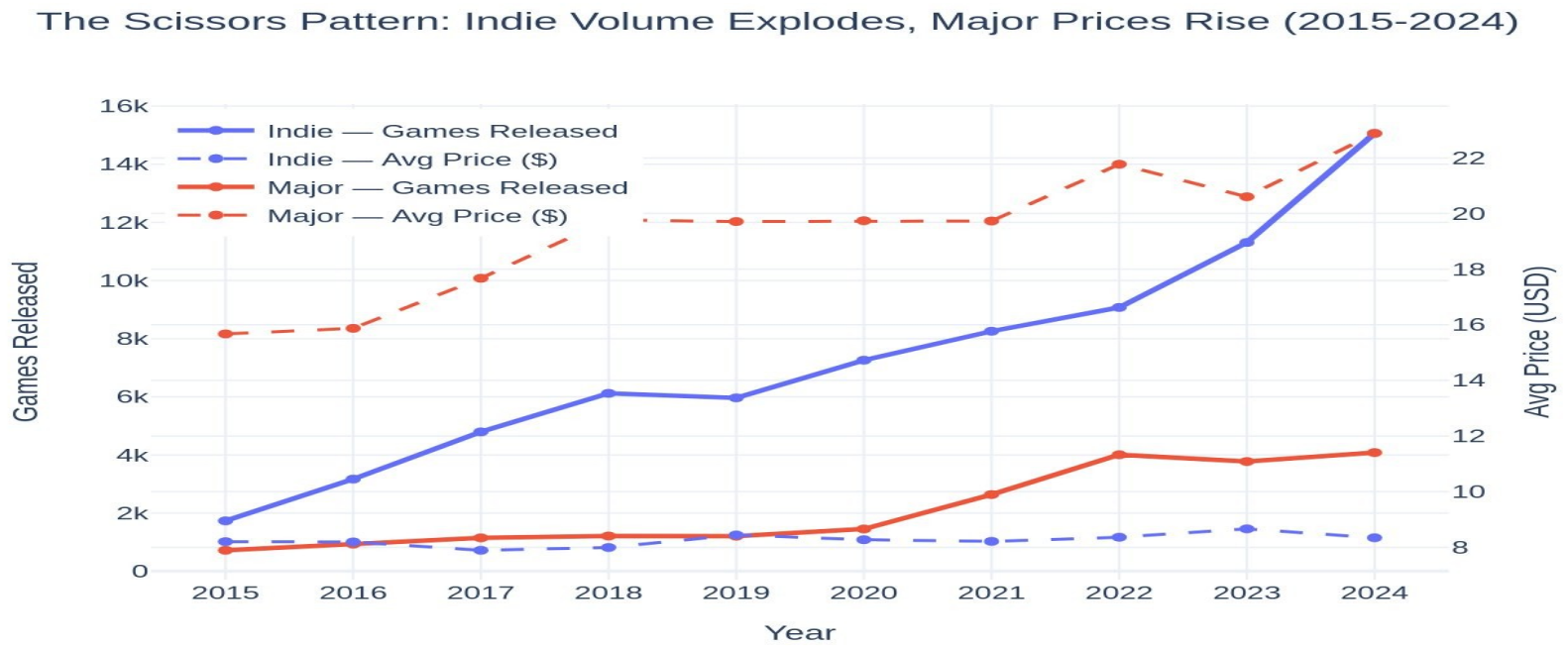
Welch's t-test (unequal samples: 104 majors vs 40,743 indies) confirms the price gap is statistically significant, not random.



FINDING #6

The Scissors Pattern (2015–2024)

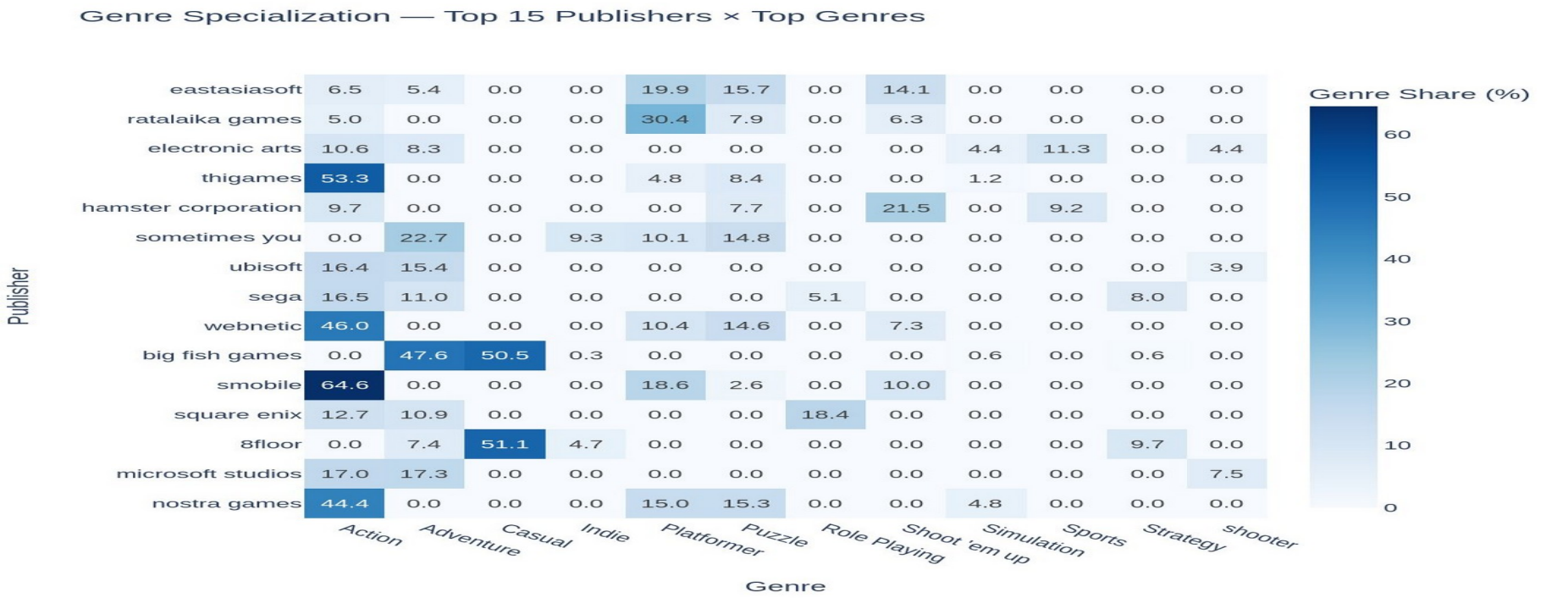
Indies grew 8.5× in volume but prices stayed flat at ~$8. Majors grew 5.7× AND raised prices 46%. Two diverging strategies.



FINDING #7

Genre Specialization Reveals Publisher DNA

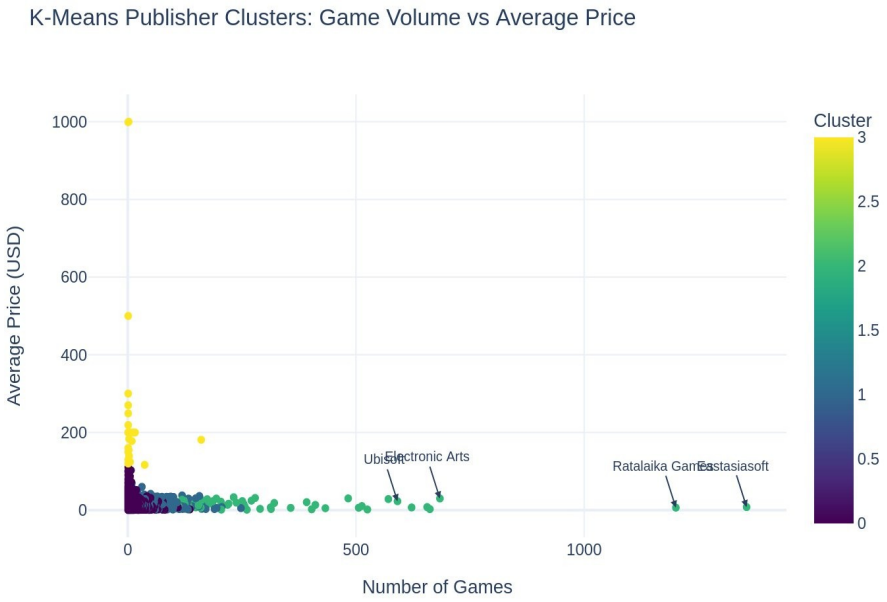
Volume publishers concentrate in Action/Platformer. AAA publishers spread across genres. Some publishers are 50%+ in a single genre.



ML: UNSUPERVISED

K-Means Finds 4 Natural Publisher Clusters

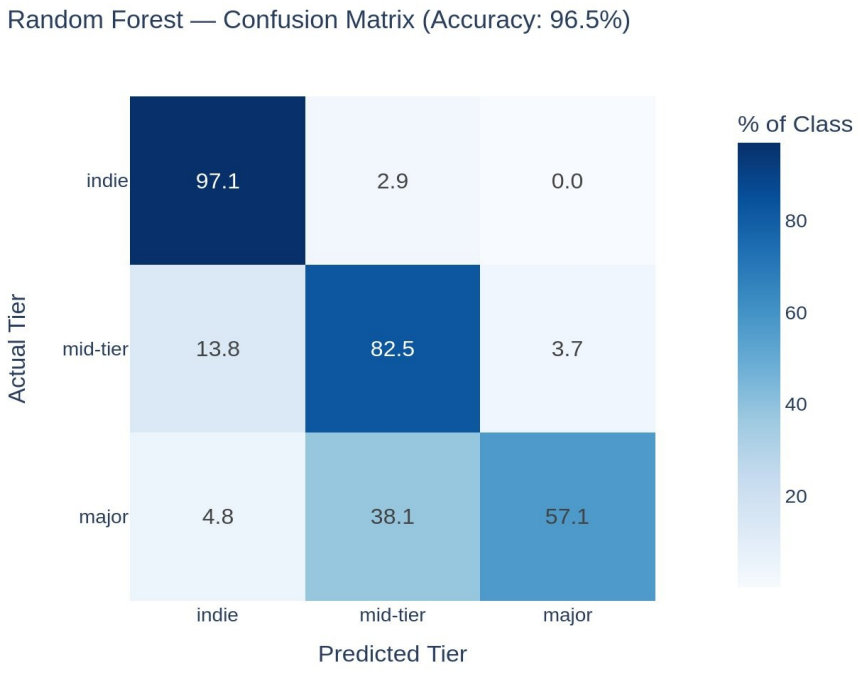
Elbow method selected K=4. Machine learning independently found the AAA vs Volume split we observed in descriptive analysis.

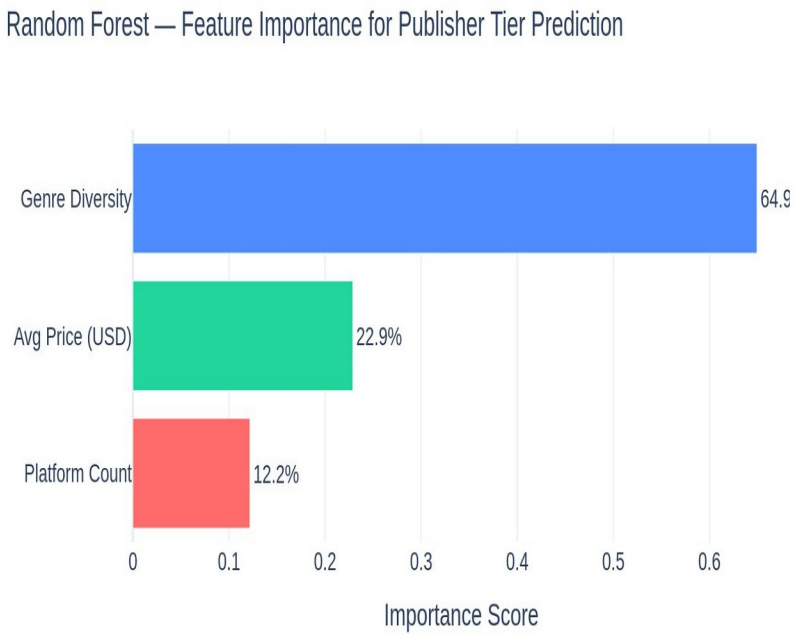


ML: SUPERVISED — RANDOM FOREST

Publisher Tier Is Predictable (96.5% Accuracy)

Genre diversity is the #1 predictor (64.9%). Indies predicted at 97.1% accuracy. class_weight='balanced' handles 49K vs 105 imbalance.

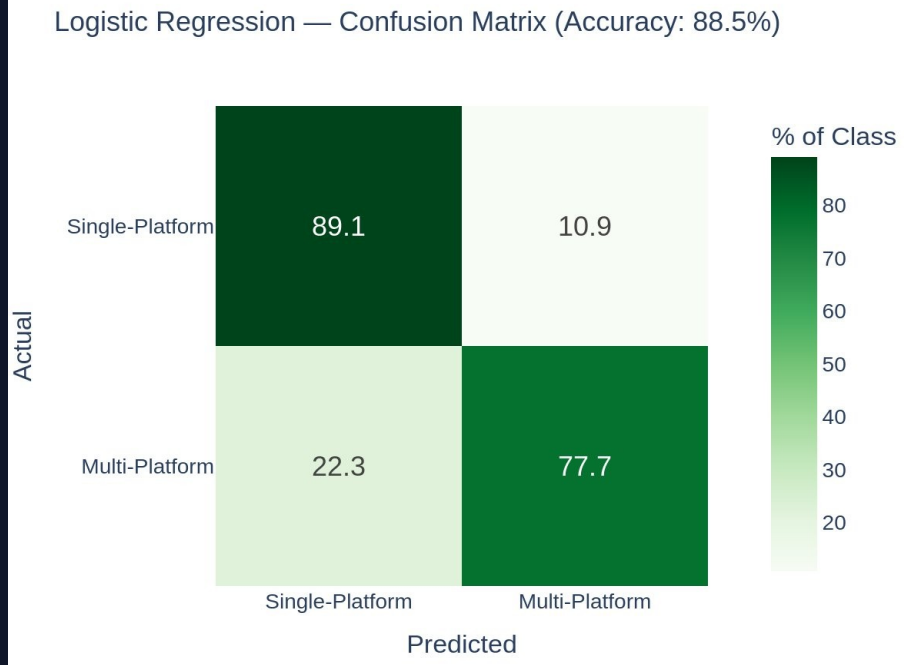


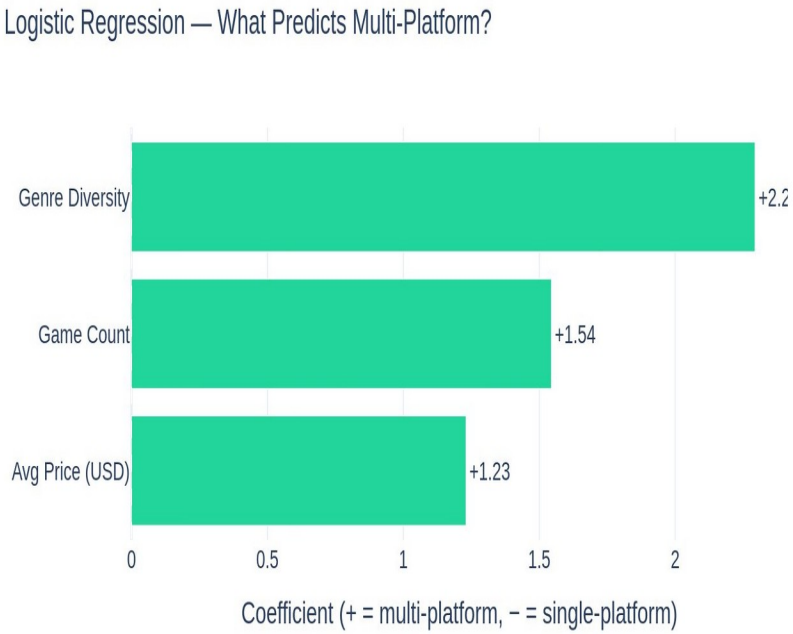


ML: SUPERVISED — LOGISTIC REGRESSION

What Drives Multi-Platform Expansion?

88.5% accuracy. All 3 coefficients positive — genre diversity (+2.22), game count (+1.54), avg price (+1.23) all push toward multi-platform.





THE ML STORY ARC

Three Models, One Validation Chain

1 K-Means

Unsupervised

Found 4 natural publisher clusters without any labels. Exploratory — "what groups exist?"

Finding:

AAA vs Volume split exists naturally in the data

2 Random Forest

Supervised

Proved publisher tiers are predictable from observable features. Confirmatory — "are tiers real?"

Finding:

Tier is predictable from price, platforms, genres

3 Logistic Regression

Supervised

Identified what drives the single→multi-platform transition. Explanatory — "what causes it?"

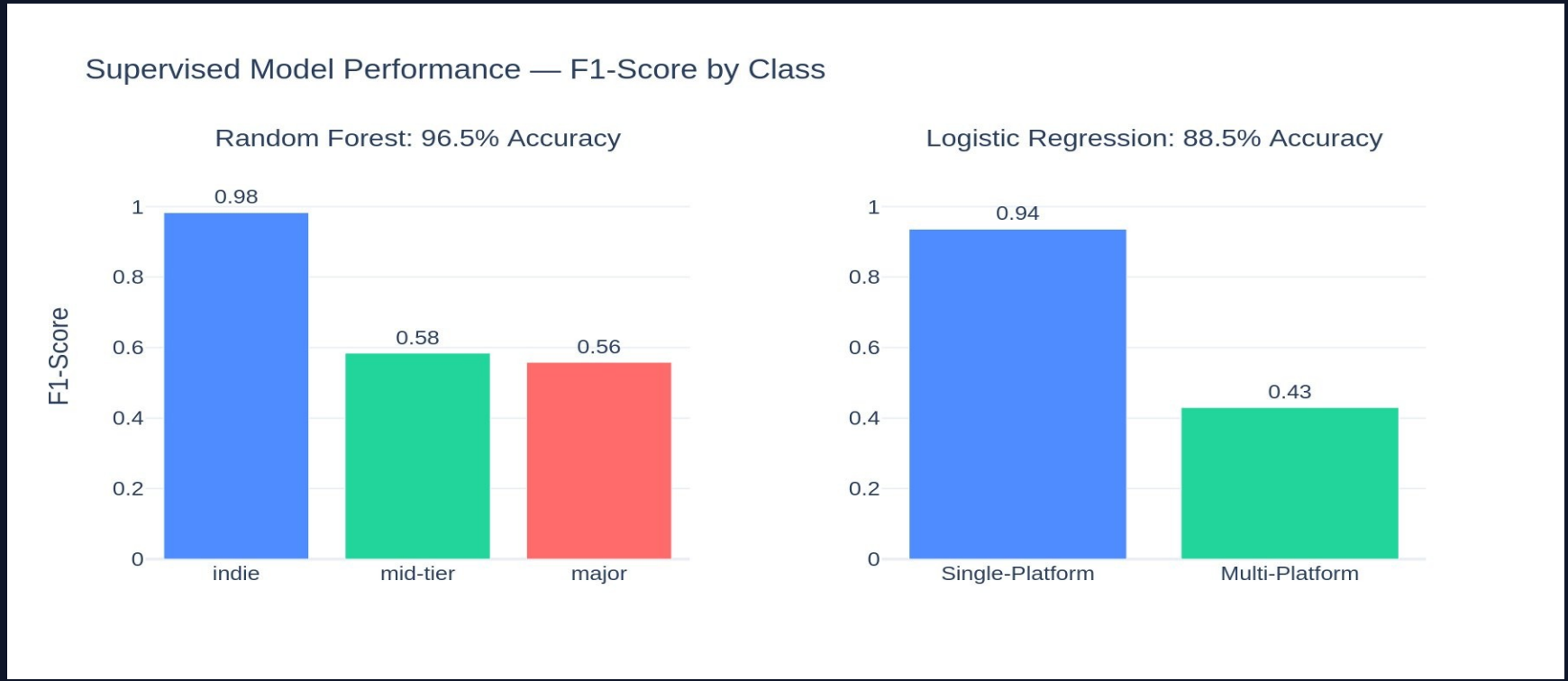
Finding:

Game count drives platform expansion

MODEL PERFORMANCE

Supervised Model Results — F1-Score by Class

Random Forest excels at indie detection (0.98 F1). Logistic Regression identifies single-platform publishers at 0.94 F1.



KEY FINDINGS

01 No single publisher dominates any platform (max 5.1% on PS)

02 95% of publishers operate on only one platform

03 Tri-platform publishers (2%) outperform on every metric: 15× games, 2× price, 7× genres

04 Steam is 76% budget games. PS is balanced. Xbox leans mid-range.

05 96.6% of indie publishers are single-platform locked

06 Scissors pattern: Indies grew 8.5× (flat prices). Majors grew 5.7× (prices +46%).

07 Eastasiasoft is #1 by volume (1,356 games) — bigger than EA — zero Steam presence

08 T-test: major vs indie price gap is statistically significant ($p < 0.001$)

09 K-Means → Random Forest → Logistic Regression: three models validate one story

RECOMMENDATIONS

For Indie Publishers

Consider dual-platform strategy — even 2 platforms doubles avg game count and price power

Specialize deeply in 1–2 genres rather than competing broadly

Build catalog volume first — game count is the strongest predictor of multi-platform success

For Platform Holders

PS: Volume publishers drive catalog size — Eastasiasoft alone is 5% of PS games

Xbox: Strongest mid-range pricing — opportunity for AAA exclusives

Steam: Budget-heavy (76%) — premium curation could capture underserved segment

For Analysts

Publisher tiers (indie/mid/major) are data-driven, not assumed — use volume thresholds

Unsupervised→supervised is a powerful ML validation chain

Cross-platform analysis requires careful publisher name normalization

THANK YOU

Questions?

Poi • Workintech Data Science Program

github.com/workintechpoyrazaka-sketch/gaming-publisher-analysis

Tools: BigQuery SQL • Python (Pandas, Plotly, scipy, scikit-learn)